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CS 1060 HW2 Design

Idea: A Mobile application that gamifies daily commutes and movement that encourages users to take eco-friendly modes of commuting while allowing users to interact on the app through shareable progress, shareable commutes, and trips.

Similar Services:

- **Pave Commute:** Pave Commute is a commute-tracking application that is workplace-oriented and is designed for employers to promote carpooling and eco-friendly travel to work
 - Focuses solely within small groups for company purposes, creates little social interaction, and offers few opportunities to post or share commute
- **Strava:** Strava is a movement tracking application that is focused on tracking training and performance, with a social interaction aspect that allows users to view one another's activity and progress.
 - Focuses on social interaction and athletic performance, but does not capture other forms of movement, and commutes for users who are not into fitness

Product Distinction

Although there are many variations of commuting applications currently available that are focused on sustainability, navigation, and progress tracking, the proposed application would be more applicable to the general public, from students to full-time employees, which allows people to connect over an everyday part of their lives. This application would take the best of Pave Commute and Strava by combining the eco-friendly encouragement and incentives, and regular social aspects to make everyday commutes more enjoyable while being a motivator for better sustainability and wellness.

Currently, apps such as Strava, BeReal, and Duolingo have demonstrated the success of focusing on lightweight, everyday social applications that allow users to personally track their progress while regularly viewing and posting about their daily activities. With sustainability and

commuting being a large part of young people's lives in both urban and school settings, the application would target an eager audience looking to track and share their daily trips, walks, and commutes, while also seeing the details of their friends' trips.

Stakeholders

- Users: Main participants. Motivated by peer recognition, eco-consciousness, and progress-based rewards. Expected behavior: share commutes, comment/like on friends' activity.
- Friends & Social Groups: Act as the engagement loop. Motivated by connection and playful competition. Expected behavior: create/join group challenges, cheer each other on, follow each other's progress, pictures, and trip details
- Local Businesses: Provide discounts/rewards tied to achievements (e.g., free coffee after 10 bus rides). Motivated by visibility. Opportunity to take advantage of being on-site/recognized by commuters nearby
- Transit Agencies & City Programs: Indirect stakeholders; may support with data partnerships. Motivated by ridership and climate goals.
- Investors / Owners: Motivated by user growth and monetization through partnerships and advertisements
- Employees/Developers: Motivated by building a viral, socially engaging app.

User Journey

Primary User: The Social Commuter

Persona: Paula, 21, college student living in Boston, bikes 3 days a week, often takes the T, loves long walks, and does not own a car. Loves sharing everyday wins and pretty photos with friends on social media and frequently tracks their steps using their phone.

Onboarding

Paula signs up and connects with her friends by syncing contacts or inviting them directly.

First Post

Paula bikes to work. The app tracks the route, generates a post:

“🚴 Paula biked 4 miles today, saving 2kg of CO₂. Streak: Day 3!”

She then shares it to her feed along with photos and a short caption talking about how great the weather was on her way to Allston. Friends give her 👍 reactions and leave comments like “Weather looks great!”

Social Loop

Paula scrolls through her feed, sees friends walking, carpooling, or hitting milestones.

She comments encouragement, joins a “September Walk Challenge” created by her friend group.

Achievements

After two weeks, Paula earns the badge “Bike Commuter Lv. 1” and posts it.

Her group collectively saves 100kg of CO₂, unlocking a team badge that connects their profiles together and displays publicly their achievement.

Rewards & Motivation

Paula sees her progress and the amount of emissions she has reduced over the last week and feels proud and excited. She sees the routes her friends have been taking to class and to nearby restaurants and thinks the photos they posted were pretty and scenic. She decides to take the route herself. The positive feedback cycle keeps her motivated.

Value Tensions

User vs. Friends: Some may prefer competition, others encouragement. Solution: customizable modes (competitive vs collaborative challenges).

User vs. Local Businesses: Businesses want exposure, users don’t want spam. Solution: only “earned/claimed” reward posts are shared and viewable.

User vs. Regulators: Cities may want data, but users value privacy. Solution: aggregated, anonymized reporting.